Talha Khan

Senior Game Developer - Software Engineer

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PROFILE

Unity/C# engineer with **complete ownership of the game engineering lifecycle**, from prototyping and architecture to optimization, LiveOps, DevOps, testing and Android/iOS delivery. Combines **F2P economy and monetization expertise** with hands-on development, technical leadership and reviewed AI-assisted CLI/MCP workflows.

EXPERIENCE

9+ years in Unity/C# development; **30+ published mobile titles**. Selected public games exceed **100M combined downloads**.

Ajax Studios — Lahore, Pakistan — Aug 2019 - Present

Technical Team Lead | Current role; progressed through Junior, Senior and Dev Lead roles

Balanstein

UNITY | UGS | FIREBASE | ADS + IAP

Physics-driven F2P arcade mobile game | Active production development, unreleased

- **Built Balanstein from scratch in Unity** and own its complete engineering lifecycle through current production development.

GAME DESIGN & ECONOMY

- **Designed F2P economies and progression systems** with resource sinks, retention and replayability mechanics; built adaptive difficulty driven by individual player-performance data.
- **Built gameplay and physics prototypes and custom level-design tools** supporting approximately 800 levels and repeatable content creation.

CORE ARCHITECTURE & PERFORMANCE

- **Engineered Unity/C# architecture and deterministic physics** for cross-platform behavior; refactored production code using SOLID principles, design patterns and code review.
- **Built animated UI across mobile aspect ratios and 28 languages**, including Arabic RTL, with Addressables; integrated VFX and collaborated with technical artists on character animation.
- **Profiled CPU/GPU frame time, memory, garbage collection and rendering** against a 30-60 FPS target on devices with 3 GB RAM; used findings to guide optimization.

LIVEOPS, BACKEND & MONETIZATION

- **Integrated UGS and Firebase game services** for authentication, Cloud Save/Code, leaderboards, analytics, Remote Config, Firestore and FCM; modeled service costs for infrastructure planning.
- **Implemented ad mediation, IAP and attribution integrations** with AppLovin MAX, AdMob, Unity Ads, AppsFlyer and Adjust; connected monetization analytics and A/B testing.

LEADERSHIP & PRODUCTION

- **Grew engineering from one developer to eight** through hiring, training and mentoring while remaining responsible for implementation, architecture, debugging and code quality.
- **Delivered Android/iOS builds and store releases across studio projects**, coordinating internal, alpha and closed testing with QA, automated Unity tests and CI/CD.
- **Introduced reviewed AI-assisted CLI and MCP workflows**, applying engineering judgment and code review to generated implementations and developer tooling.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

ZEKAB International Limited
Rawalpindi, Pakistan — May 2018 - Jun 2019

Game Developer

- **Shipped 16 Unity titles to Google Play in 13 months** from approximately 20 prototypes, building gameplay, progression, IAP, ads, leaderboards and achievements.
- Helped establish the studio's Unity workflow and mentored junior developers and interns.

Desire Studios
Rawalpindi, Pakistan — Jul 2017 - Apr 2018

Game Developer | promoted from Intern

- **Designed, developed and published 18 mobile titles** across hyper-casual, simulation and puzzle genres, handling concept-to-deployment engineering and device optimization with designers and artists.
- **Awarded Employee of the Month five consecutive times** for the lowest crash rates in my games and creative ideas.
- **Refactored and optimized code for 23 additional studio games** to reduce crash rates and fatal errors.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Unity & Gameplay
Unity 2D/3D, C#, gameplay architecture, deterministic physics, ScriptableObjects, custom controllers, Input System, Blend Trees, pooling, save/load, prototyping, Netcode

Software Engineering
OOP, SOLID, clean architecture, design patterns, data structures & algorithms, async/await, refactoring, code review

Graphics & Animation
URP/HDRP, Shader Graph, HLSL shaders, particle systems, post-processing, VFX, character animation, technical-artist collaboration

UI & Localization
uGUI, pixel-perfect and animated UI, Canvas/Sprite Atlas optimization, aspect ratios, localization, Arabic RTL

Profiling & Diagnostics
Unity Profiler, CPU/GPU and device profiling, frame-time/FPS, memory management, GC/draw-call reduction, Android logcat, device debugging

Testing & QA
Unity Test Framework, automated tests, internal/alpha/closed testing, cross-platform and device validation, bug tracking, pre-release QA

LiveOps & Backend
UGS: Cloud Save, Cloud Code, Auth, Leaderboards, Analytics, Remote Config; Firebase Auth/Firestore/FCM/Analytics/Remote Config; REST APIs

F2P & Game Economies
Economy design, resource sinks, progression, retention, replayability, adaptive difficulty, game business models, monetization analytics, A/B testing

Monetization & Attribution
AppLovin MAX, AdMob, Unity Ads, ad mediation, SDK integration, in-app purchases, AppsFlyer, Adjust

Release Pipeline & DevOps
Android/iOS, Google Play/App Store, Xcode, Android Studio, CI/CD, Unity Cloud Build, Git, Addressables, Asset Bundles, custom editor tooling

Supporting Languages & AI
C++, Python, Java, JavaScript; CLI/MCP workflows with Claude Code, Unity MCP, Cursor and Codex; reviewed AI-assisted implementation

Leadership & Production
Hiring, mentoring, technical guidance, Agile/sprint planning, code review, collaboration with designers, artists and QA

GENRES & GAME MODELS

Vehicle Simulation | Physics Arcade | Hyper-casual | Puzzle | Action / Shooter | Free-to-play (F2P) | Live Service

EDUCATION

Riphah International University
BS (Hons) Software Engineering
Islamabad, Pakistan | 2013 - 2017